

3.4.5 Codes and conventions

Content	Guidance notes
The codes and conventions of media language, how they develop and become established as 'styles' or genres (which are common across different media products) and how they may also vary over time.	Varieties of code: Technical codes: moving image and photographic • Shot types and camera movement • Composition and lighting • Editing • Audio: diegetic and non-diegetic sound, dialogue Print codes: design, layout and typography • Colour • Juxtaposition and superimposition • House style, fonts and grids Symbolic codes • Mise-en-scène: costume, lighting, location, actors, make-up and hair, props, set dressing Verbal and non-verbal codes • Use of language including word choice, formality, complexity • Dress, appearance and body movement Paralanguage
Theoretical perspectives on genre: • principles of repetition and variation • the dynamic nature of genre • hybridity • intertextuality. Intertextuality, including how inter-relationships between different media products can influence meaning.	The evolution and development of genres (including hybrid genres) in different media forms. Factors influencing the creation of genre products: • financial • cultural • audience demand.